

Medford School Committee Meeting

April 26, 2021

Remote Meeting by ZOOM

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

Pursuant to Governor Baker's March 12, 2020 Order Suspending Certain Provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §18, and the Governor's March 15, 2020 Order imposing strict limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place, this meeting of the Medford School Committee will be conducted via remote participation to the greatest extent possible. Specific information and the general guidelines for remote participation by members of the public and/or parties with a right and/or requirement to attend this meeting can be found on the City of Medford website, at www.medfordma.org. For this meeting, members of the public who wish to listen or watch the meeting may do so by accessing the meeting link contained herein. No in-person attendance of members of the public will be permitted, but every effort will be made to ensure that the public can adequately access the proceedings in real time, via technological means. In the event that we are unable to do so, despite best efforts, we will post on the City of Medford or Medford Community Media websites an audio or video recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting.

Additionally, questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

1. Your first and last name
2. Your Medford street address
3. Your question or comment

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/91506415713>

Meeting ID: 915 0641 5713

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Find your local number: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/u/abnFMzA5yQ>

I. Roll Call and Salute the Flag

II. Approval of Minutes:

1. April 12, 2021 School Committee Meeting

III. Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls

IV. Report of Secretary

1. Good of the Order - *Offered by Melanie McLaughlin*

V. Report of Committees

1. Behavioral Health and Special Education Subcommittee Meeting, April 15, 2021 - Melanie McLaughlin, Chair

VI. Community Participation

Any citizen in the audience may be given permission to speak once at School Committee meetings regarding any item on the agenda for up to three minutes on any one item.

A Community Participation portion of the agenda is established which will give any citizen the privilege of placing any item before the School Committee or be heard on any item. Any item to be presented must be submitted in writing to the Superintendent of Schools by the Wednesday noon prior to the scheduled meeting, with a maximum of five (5) minutes allowed for any one presentation

Public Participation Emails: Questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

1. Your first and last name
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Parent, Maureen Ronayne, Topic: Dyslexia

VII. Report of Superintendent

1. Superintendent's Updates and Comments
2. COVID-19 Public Health Update & MPS COVID-19 Testing Summary and Update - Nurse Supervisor Toni Wray, Ms. MaryAnn O'Connor - Board of Health & Mr. David Murphy
3. Update on FY 22 Budget Preparation
4. Report on Summer Fun and Community Schools, Dr. Peter Cushing, Robert Maloney
5. Recommendation to approve 2021-2022 School Year Calendar
6. Update on discounted MBTA Bus Passes for Disadvantaged Students - David Murphy

VIII. Old Business

IX. Communications

X. New Business

1. Resolution in Support of Expedited COVID-19 Vaccinations for Students

Whereas as of April 12, 2021, the Coronavirus (COVID-19) pandemic has infected over 30.4 million individuals in the United States and has resulted in more than 551,638 deaths across the country and 17,185 in Massachusetts;

Whereas our strong public education system, which is essential to the individual and community well-being of our society, is facing unprecedented challenges due to the Coronavirus pandemic and lack of clear national, state, and local direction or resources. These challenges include, but are not limited to, the academic and social-emotional toll on students, as well as the need to rapidly pivot to distance learning; clean and equip school facilities to adapt to new health protocols and social distancing; assess and address the risks to teachers, staff, and students;

Whereas vaccines are proven to be the most effective strategy to reduce and eliminate the spread of infectious diseases and are an important and necessary tool for eradicating disease and vaccines are anticipated to be approved for use for some school aged children in the coming weeks;

Whereas the current Commonwealth vaccine distribution system created access issues for eligible residents that could create greater access disparities among school aged children; and

Whereas Medford Public Schools is committed to the health and safety of its students and staff;
now, therefore, be it

Resolved, that the Medford School Committee:

1. calls on the State Legislature, the Governor, the Massachusetts Department of Public Health, create a vaccine rollout plan for school aged children that puts the distribution in the hands of local officials and eliminates accessibility barriers to students and their families;
2. calls on the Massachusetts Association of School Committees (MASC) to publicly advocate for local control of vaccine distribution for school aged children; and
3. directs the district the Superintendent to transmit official copies of this resolution to the following: the Commissioner of the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education, the Governor of Massachusetts, Senator Elizabeth Warren, Senator Edward Markey, Congresswoman Katherine Clark, State Senator Patricia Jehlen, State Representative Paul Donato, State Representative Sean Garballey, State Representative Christine Barber, and the Massachusetts Association of School Committees (MASC).

-Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau

2. Whereas the current School Committee Policy GCA - PROFESSIONAL STAFF POSITIONS states:

All professional staff positions in the school system will be created initially by the School Committee. It is the Committee's intent to activate a sufficient number of positions to accomplish the school system's goals and objectives and to provide for the equitable staffing of each school building. Although such positions may remain temporarily unfilled, only the Committee may abolish a position it has created.

Each time a new position is established by the Committee, the Superintendent will present for the Committee's approval a job description for the position, which specifies the jobholder's qualifications and the job's performance responsibilities. The Superintendent will maintain a comprehensive set of job descriptions for all positions.

NOTE: Job descriptions for professional staff positions are available for review in the office of the Superintendent.

Be it resolved that the School Committee amends policy GCA - Professional Staff Positions to ensure transparency, relevancy, and accountability across all professional staff job functions.

All professional staff positions in the school system will be created initially by the School Committee. It is the Committee's intent to activate a sufficient number of positions to accomplish the school system's goals and objectives and to provide for the equitable staffing of each school building. Professional Staff is defined as department heads, central office staff, nursing,

The Superintendent will maintain a comprehensive list of positions and set of job descriptions for all positions. All job descriptions will be reviewed every three years and presented to the School Committee for approval. Job descriptions will contain a last reviewed date. The Superintendent will establish a review cycle for all position descriptions within 60 days of the adoption of this policy. The initial review cycle will last for no longer than three years and conclude by September 1, 2024.

Effective September 1, 2021, the comprehensive list and current job descriptions for professional staff positions are available for review by the public on the MPS website.

Each time a new position is established by the Committee, the Superintendent will present for the Committee's approval a job description for the position, which specifies the jobholder's qualifications and the job's performance responsibilities.

Although such positions may remain temporarily unfilled, only the Committee may abolish a position it has created.

All positions unfilled for the entire prior school year will be reported to the Committee annually no later than June 1st, with an explanation for the vacancy.

All positions that remain unfilled for more than two consecutive school years will be presented to the Committee to be abolished no later than June 1st. In the event the Superintendent wishes to maintain any positions that have been unfilled for more than two consecutive school years the Superintendent must explain the rationale and plan to fill the position and get approval from the Committee to continue the unfilled position for an additional year.

- *Offered by Jenny Graham and Paul Ruseau (Tabled from 4.12.2021 School Committee Meeting)*

3. On March 16, 2021, the Education Committee of the Mystic Valley Area NAACP sent the School Committee a letter thanking us for our work this year on the following issues:

- a) The renaming efforts of the Columbus Elementary School.
- b) The end of out-of-school suspensions policy.
- c) The focus on hiring and recruitment of BIPOC candidates to teaching and administrative positions as well as maintaining our current BIPOC staff members.

I request that the letter be entered into the record and would like to read the letter in its entirety.

- *Offered by Paul Ruseau*

4. As required by MGL Chapter 71 Section 38M that the School Committee must designate a Student Outreach Coordinator, the School Committee hereby designates Dr. Peter Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Secondary Education for Medford Public Schools to the role of Student Outreach Coordinator.

- *Offered by Paul Ruseau*

3. School Committee Resolution: Condolences:

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Edward Michael Hunt, father in law of Rosin Hunt, Administrative Assistant for Athletics.

The Medford School Committee offers its sincere condolences to the family of Therese Sweeney, wife of the late James Sweeney, who was a longtime teacher at Medford High School.